GOURMET RECIPE CARD

Foolproof Eggless Cinnamon Rolls

Pillowy brioche swirls, dark brown-sugar cinnamon, cream cheese glaze — no eggs, no fear.

Makes 12 · Prep 30 min + 2 hrs rising · **Bake 180°C · 22–25 min**



Ingredients

Tangzhong (the foolproof secret)

- 30 g bread flour
- 150 ml whole milk

Dough

- 500 g bread flour
- 60 g caster sugar
- 7 g instant dry yeast (1 sachet)
- 8 g fine sea salt
- 120 ml warm whole milk (lukewarm, ~37°C)
- 60 g plain whole-milk yogurt, room temp
- 60 g unsalted butter, soft
- All of the tangzhong

Cinnamon filling

- 110 g unsalted butter, very soft
- 160 g dark brown sugar
- 22 g ground Ceylon cinnamon
- 3 g fine sea salt

Cream cheese glaze

- 150 g full-fat cream cheese, room temp
- 50 g unsalted butter, soft
- 120 g icing sugar, sifted
- 5 ml vanilla extract
- Pinch of fine sea salt
- 15–30 ml warm milk, to loosen

Method

1. **Tangzhong:** whisk flour and milk in a small pan over medium heat, stirring constantly, until thick like custard (~65°C, 3–4 min). Cover surface-touching; cool to room temp.
2. **Mix:** combine flour, sugar, yeast, salt in a stand-mixer bowl. Add warm milk, yogurt and all the tangzhong. Mix to a shaggy dough.
3. **Knead:** add soft butter; knead 10–12 min until smooth, elastic, passing the windowpane test. Soft and slightly tacky is right.
4. **First rise:** cover; rest somewhere warm 1–1½ hrs until doubled.
5. **Filling:** mash butter, brown sugar, cinnamon and salt into a spreadable paste.
6. **Shape:** roll dough to a 40 × 30 cm rectangle; spread filling edge to edge. Roll tightly from the long side; cut into 12 with dental floss.
7. **Second rise:** arrange in a buttered 23 × 33 cm pan, barely touching. Cover 40–50 min until puffy.
8. **Bake:** 180°C (160°C fan), 22–25 min, deep golden. Slightly underbake — carryover heat finishes them.
9. **Glaze:** whisk glaze ingredients, loosening with warm milk to a thick pour. Spread over warm — not hot — rolls.

Why it can't fail

- **Tangzhong** pre-gelatinizes starch so the crumb holds water for days — pillowy without a single egg.
- **Yogurt** brings the fat and gentle acidity an egg would; the dough stays tender, never bready.
- **Lukewarm milk only** — hot milk kills yeast, the number-one cinnamon roll murder.
- **Dental floss** cuts without squashing the swirl. A knife drags; floss glides.
- **Frost warm, serve warm** — the glaze melts into every spiral, and hides a multitude of sins.